

Eugene "Gene" Vestel, MBA

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AI and healthcare technology leader. Two decades across pharmacy, payer, provider, and digital health — building data platforms, quality analytics, and AI agent infrastructure. Founder of HealthClaw (open-source HIPAA-aware security and audit layer for AI agents on clinical data). Host of the *Out of the FHIR* podcast; author of the *FHIR IQ Playbook* newsletter.

EXPERIENCE

VP of AI — Data, AI & Analytics · Technology platform	2025 – present
Leading data and AI strategy across product, engineering, and analytics teams.	
Founder (open-source side project) · HealthClaw	2025 – present
HIPAA-aware security and audit layer for AI agents working on clinical data: PHI redaction on read, multi-step human approval for clinical writes, HMAC-confirmed immutable audit; mapped to the OWASP Agentic AI Top 10 and the 2025 HIPAA Security Rule update.	
Digital Quality & FHIR Advisor · NCQA	Mar 2025 – Aug 2025
Advised on the next generation of digital quality measurement and the FHIR conformance work underneath it.	
Director of Analytics · b.well Connected Health	2022 – 2025
Built the FHIR data ingestion, provider directory, and clinical data layers for a consumer health-records platform.	
Manager, Strategic Data Management & Quality Analytics · UPMC Health Plan	2017 – 2022
Five years leading HEDIS, patient-safety, and operational quality analytics, with roughly \$180M in cumulative impact across those programs.	
Manager, Business Intelligence · Allegheny Health Network	2014 – 2016
Data Warehouse Architect → Sr. Data Warehouse Engineer · I.D. Systems / EDMC	2013 – 2014
Sr. Data Reconciliation Analyst, Medicare Part D · Express Scripts	2010 – 2013
Systems Analyst · Medco Health Solutions	2007 – 2010
Manager, Pharmacy Business Analysis · Duane Reade	2003 – 2007

EDUCATION

MBA, Healthcare · University of Pittsburgh — Katz School of Business	2016 – 2018
B.S., Business Administration & Management · Brooklyn College	2002 – 2006

EXPERTISE

—HEDIS & digital quality measurement	—Agentic AI — agents, evals, guardrails	—FHIR R4/R6, US Core, SMART on FHIR
—Claims data analysis & data governance	—AI product management & adoption	—CMS-0057 / TEFCA, Da Vinci IGs
—Analytics strategy, BI & data products	—AI governance in regulated environments	—Model Context Protocol (MCP)

SELECTED WORK & COMMUNITY

HealthClaw — HIPAA-aware agent guardrails (healthclaw.io) · **Smart Health Connect** — SMART-on-FHIR records platform · **FHIR Builders** — implementer community site (fhirbuilders.com)

CMS RFI — authored FHIR IQ's public response on health-technology interoperability and market design · **Pittsburgh Health Analytics** — founder & organizer, 110+ members · **FHIR DevDays 2026** — speaker, HIPAA-aware AI agents